

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Al Baster

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Al Baster

Sculptor & Public-Art Star

Al considers a pedestal a sculpture that has given up on itself. Al makes monumental sculpture in stone, steel, and whatever else can require a crane.

- **Frank Lloyd Wrong** designed the entrance around Al's sculpture. They still disagree about which one visitors came to see.
- Competes with **Vincent Van Faux** for commissions. Al keeps calculating how many paintings weigh as much as one sculpture.
- **Dada DiCapo** once performed inside one of Al's sculptures. Al found out from the photographs.

ACTING TIPS

Big presence, playful arrogance, generous when admired, combative when minimized.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Al Baster. I made the entrance sculpture. I would appreciate your admiration in a tone that suggests prompt payment.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Al Baster

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant planned to replace your commissioned entrance sculpture with a cheaper replica after the opening and dispute your final payment.

Your other secret

You built one internal support differently from the approved plan because the fabricator missed a deadline.

Conversations to start

- Ask Frank Lloyd Wrong whether the entrance display still includes your original sculpture.
- Ask Vincent Van Faux how he handles patrons who try to replace an artist's work.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Find the frame that always contains a portrait of you; check its top.*
- 2 *A wall-hung painting has a backstage area. That is where to investigate.*
- 3 *A blue cushion has been acting as a very quiet accomplice. Check its reverse.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Al Baster

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Al Baster

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I changed an internal support after the fabricator missed the deadline. Grant intended to replace my original with a cheap replica and dispute the final payment. A sculpture's support is supposed to remain invisible. Apparently he wanted the sculptor's labor to follow the same principle. The mold began separating at 6:36.

IF MURDERER

The support differs from the approved drawing. Grant discovered it and used that fact to justify replacing my sculpture with a replica. He would keep the opening-night photograph and refuse the balance. I was commissioned to make art, then invited to finance his imitation of it. The mold began separating at 6:29.



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Al Baster

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Al Baster

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Both my hands held the mold until that last clamp. The earlier clamps couldn't hold both halves; letting go would have separated them. The assistant was helping close the mold around a concealed support. My drawing showed the approved design, not what I had built. Grant wanted that discrepancy used to replace the whole sculpture. I wanted to correct the drawing. Neither of us was especially interested in the other's proposal.

IF MURDERER

Both my hands held the mold until that last clamp. The earlier clamps couldn't hold both halves; letting go would have separated them. The assistant was helping close the mold around a concealed support. My drawing showed the approved design, not what I had built. Grant wanted that discrepancy used to replace the whole sculpture. I wanted to correct the drawing. Neither of us was especially interested in the other's proposal.



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Al Baster

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

When did that work or interruption end, and what were your materials used for?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What detail on the original paper or record confirms the sequence you described?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Al Baster

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The assistant tightened the final clamp at 6:46. The concealed support differs from the plan. It deserves an accurate drawing, not a patron's excuse to replace the entire sculpture.

IF MURDERER

The assistant tightened the final clamp at 6:38. The concealed support differs from the plan. It deserves an accurate drawing, not a patron's excuse to replace the entire sculpture.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Al Baster

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Al Baster

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I changed the support and owe the museum the accurate drawing. I remained holding the plaster mold with both hands across the service bells while the assistant clamped it. I couldn't leave for Grant's glass. The replica dispute made me furious. Fury does not explain away unsafe fabrication, and I will fix the part I actually made.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took C-17 during the walkthrough and concealed it in the polishing rag. I finished the mold before service, then carried the drawing to Grant between the bells and coated his coupe. The staff poured into the glass I had prepared. He threatened to replace my work. I murdered him instead of making him pay for it.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.